

Lessons Learned from a Decade of Data

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Federally funded since 2010 to coordinate data collection with TPSID projects and to provide training and technical assistance to colleges, universities, students, families, transition professionals and K-12 educators who are interested in postsecondary education opportunities for students with intellectual disability.

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options for
people with
intellectual
disability



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WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR STATE

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Transition Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSID)

Goal: to create, expand, or enhance high-quality, inclusive higher education experiences to support positive outcomes for individuals with ID.

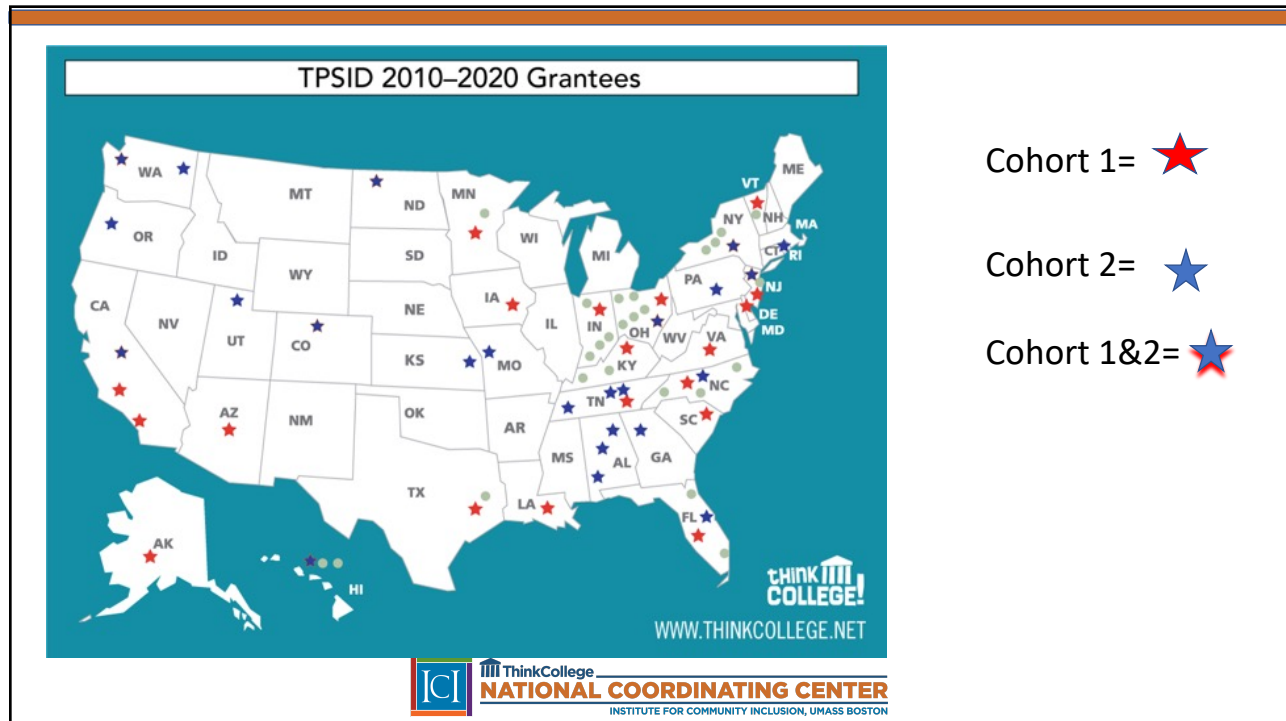


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TPSIDs represent about 1/3 of higher education programs for students with ID in the US



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TPSID Data 2019-2020

Academics



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In 2019-2020

936 students



enrolled in

6,750 courses

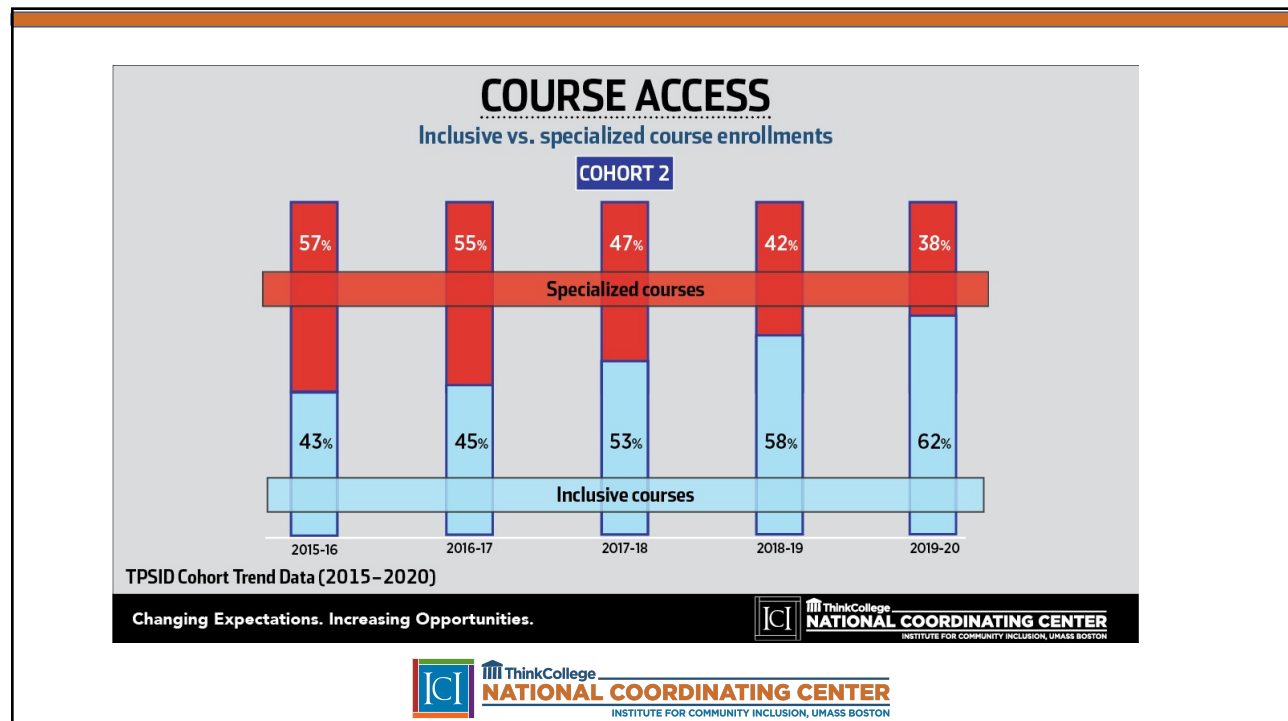


for an average of

7 courses (inclusive or specialized)
per student per year.



10



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Examples of Inclusive Courses

An Introduction to the University	Criminal Law	Encounters in Human Diversity	Fundamentals of Food Preparation	Fundamentals of Public Speaking	General Psychology
Graphic Design I	Intermediate Algebra	Introduction to Sociology	Introduction to Acting	Introduction to Sculpture Studio	Math 101
Micro-computing Systems	Office Skills I	Principles of Marketing	Race and Social Justice	Strategies for Success in College	U.S. History Since 1877



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Lessons learned

01

Prioritize inclusion from the start-it is hard to undo segregation once established

02

Ensure students get access to advising and transcripts-these are predictors of inclusion

03

Set clear expectations with faculty about student goals, role of mentors, & lines of communication



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Residential Options and Supports



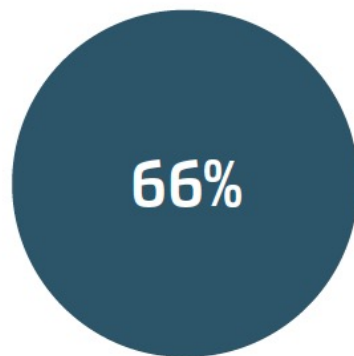
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Of the 41 TPSID programs located at residential schools, 27 (66%) offered housing and 14 did not.



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Student place of residence



Lived with family



Lived in IHE
housing



Lived in non-IHE
housing, not
with family

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Most common residential supports



Residential assistant or advisor (20/27 programs)



Intermittent or on-call support staff (13/27 programs)



Uncompensated roommate/suitemate (6/27 programs)



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Lessons Learned

01

Housing access can be a struggle. Collaborate with residential life/campus housing to gain access to campus housing.

02

Ensure choice in and access to campus-affiliated housing.

03

Design residential supports around the needs of the student and in collaboration with residential life



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Career Development and Employment



19

2019-2020 employment data are a little tricky...



Impact of COVID-19

We'll explain where it differs to previous years



20

Career awareness and exploration

In 2019–2020 most students enrolled in TPSIDs (n = 812, 85%) participated in at least one CAE activity.

TABLE 3. PARTICIPATION IN CAE ACTIVITIES IN 2019-2020

	Number of students who participated in activity (N=956*)	Percentage of students who participated in activity
Create or revise resume	752	79%
Interest inventory	615	64%
Mock interview	564	59%
Gathered references	504	53%
Labor market research	483	51%
Career fair	391	41%
Informational interview	367	38%
Company tour	333	35%
Job shadow	279	29%
Create LinkedIn profile	192	20%
Other activity	197	21%

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Paid work-based learning

- Paid WBL experiences included internships, student enterprises, and work training experiences.
- One hundred sixty-three students (17%) had at least one paid WBL experience.
- These students had a total of 327 paid WBL experiences. Ninety-seven students had multiple paid WBL experiences during the year.



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Work-based learning pay rates

66% (n = 208) paid at or above the federal minimum wage of \$7.25 per hour

34% (n=108) paid below minimum wage



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Unpaid work-based learning

42% of TPSID students (n = 401 students) participated in 652 unpaid WBL experiences.

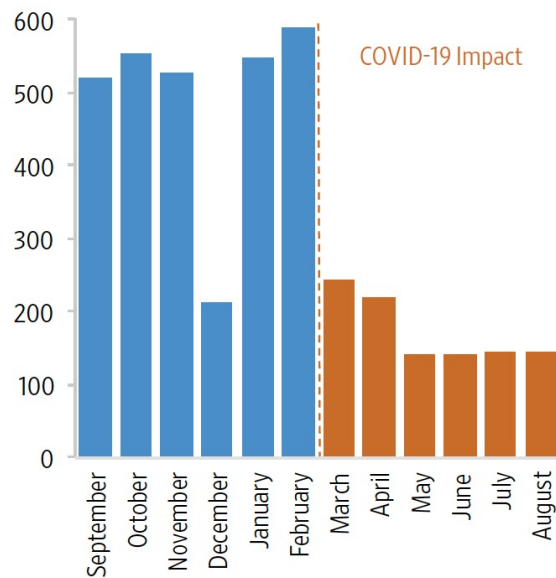
Included:

- 407 unpaid internships (62%)
- 141 unpaid work experiences (22%)
- 45 service-learning experiences (7%)



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Impact of COVID-19 on number of WBL 2019-2020



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Paid employment

- 305 students (32%) were engaged in any type of paid employment while enrolled.
- 85 students (28%) had more than one paid employment

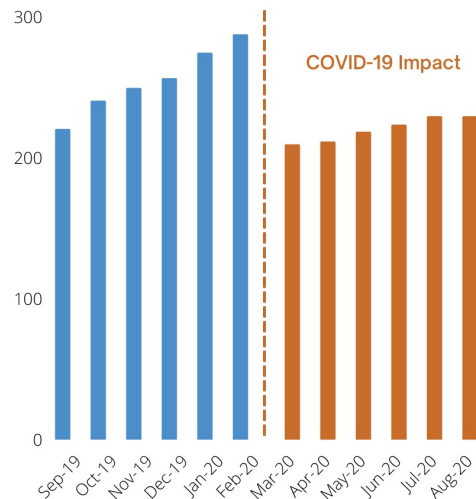
417 paid employment positions were held by students.



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Employment positions by month 2019-2020

NUMBER OF EMPLOYMENT POSITIONS BY MONTH



27



44% of students (n = 419) had at least one paid position while enrolled.

"Paid positions" combines data on paid employment and paid work-based learning

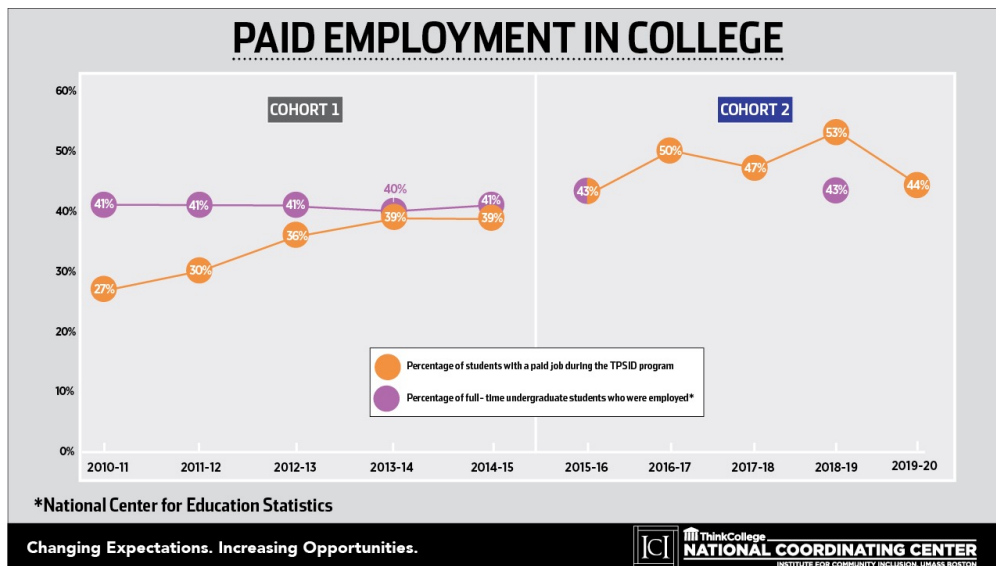
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Putting these data into a larger context

Comparisons with other college students

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PAID EMPLOYMENT IN COLLEGE



Note: Data displayed on this graph show any paid positions held by students, including paid work-based learning

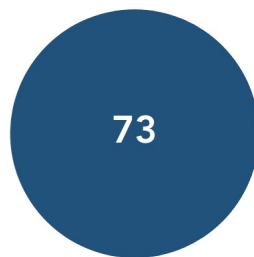
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342 students exited a TPSID program in 2019-2020

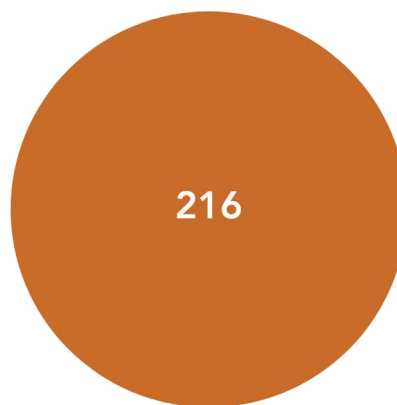


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Employment at exit



Paid job



Career development
experience

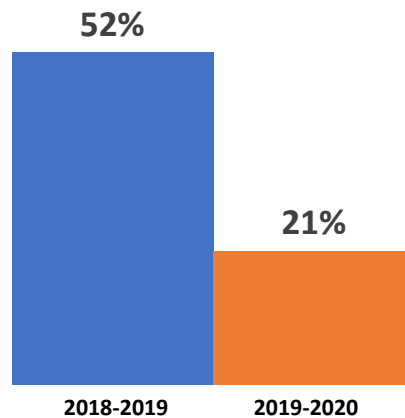


Further
postsecondary
education

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Impact of COVID on employment at exit

Percentage of students employed at exit



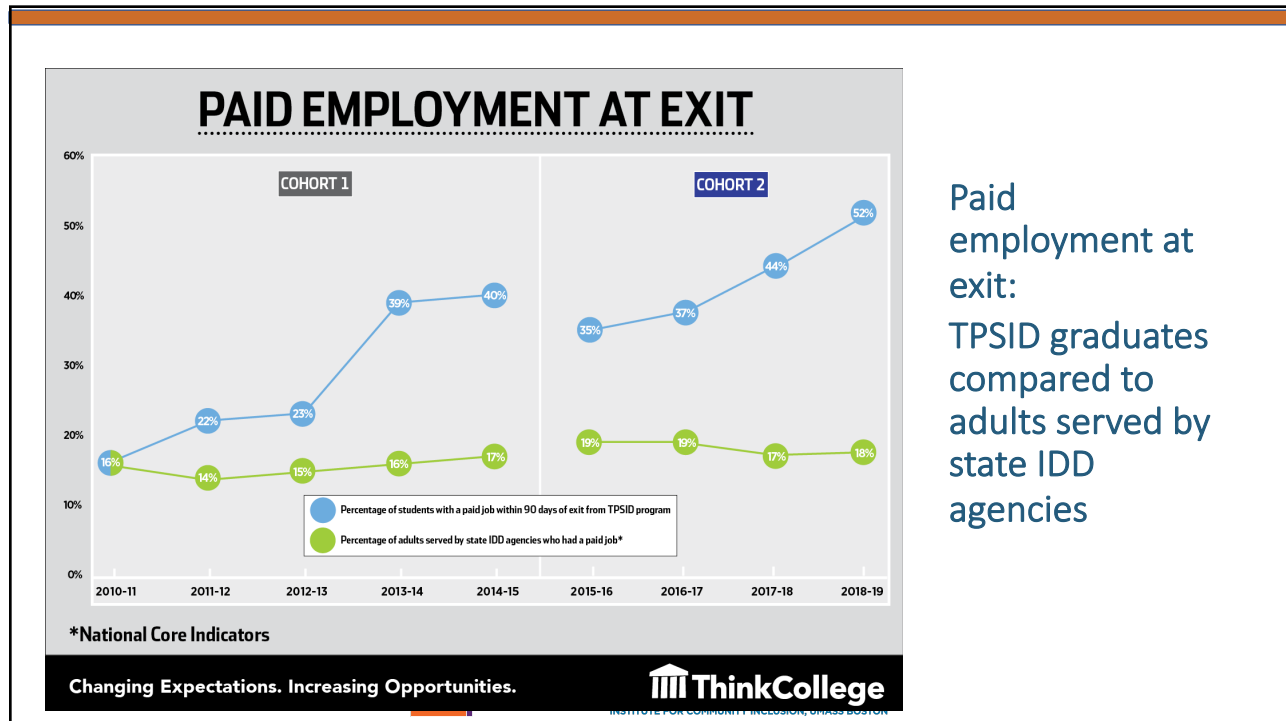
The percentage of students who had a paid job at exit or within 90 days dropped substantially in 2019-2020

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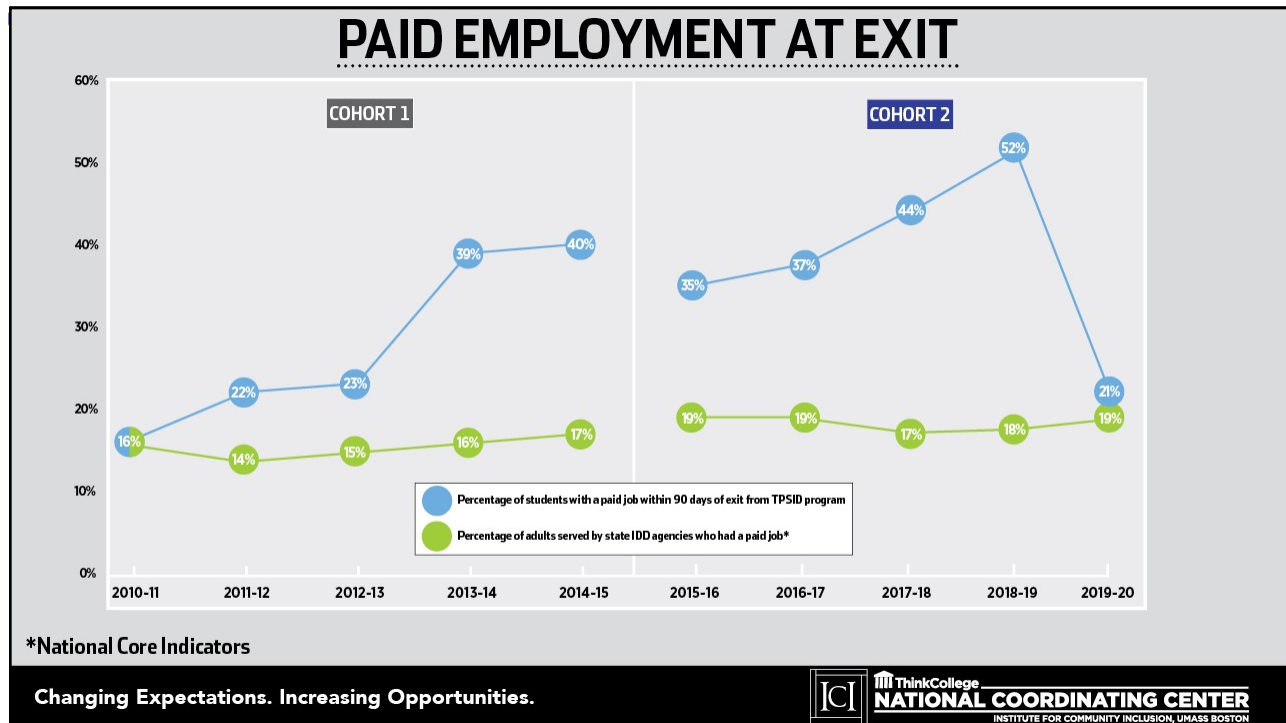
Putting these data into a larger context

Comparisons with
other adults with
IDD

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Lessons learned

01

Strong impact of pandemic on student employment rate

02

Continued emphasis on unpaid work while enrolled

03

Need to identify preparation activities that lead to employment



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Credentials



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Credentials offered



Students were able to earn a credential at all 58 programs

56 programs created a TPSID-specific credential

At the remaining 2 programs, students could earn an existing credential



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IHE Approval



Thirty-three programs (57%) offered a TPSID-specific credential that was approved by the IHE.



Eight programs offered a credential that aligned with an existing labor market credential.



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**Of the students who exited, 79%
(n = 270) completed a program and
earned a credential.**

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**The most frequent type of credential
earned by program completers was
a credential developed by the TPSID.**

**Two hundred eighteen students
earned 246 TPSID-created credentials.**



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Lessons learned

01

Credential development takes significant time and planning

02

IHE approval matters

03

Continued need to review alignment with industry recognized credentials

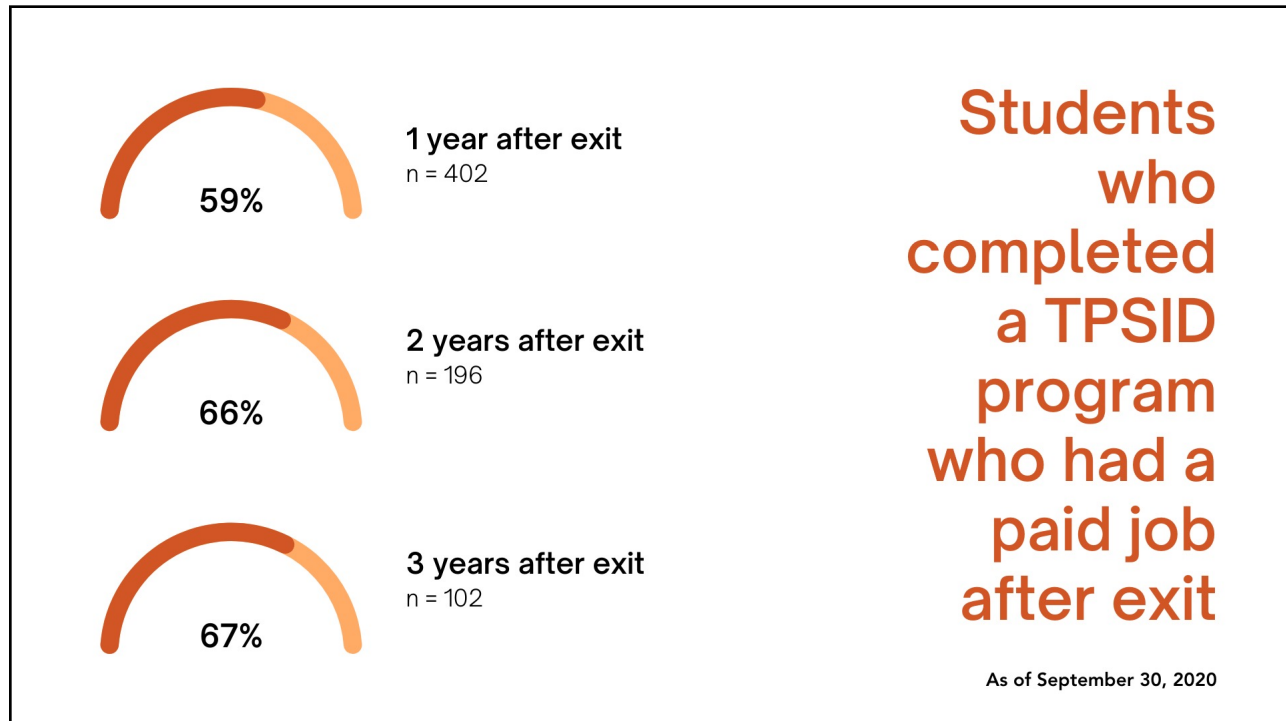


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Outcomes



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92% of respondents reported they were satisfied or very satisfied with their social life

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Living arrangements 1 & 2 years out

53% of 1-year respondents were not living with family



20-percentage points from 2019

54% of 2-year respondents were not living with family



14 percentage points from 2019



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Pursuit of further PSE

26% of 1-year respondents were pursuing further education



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Other relevant findings from TPSID data



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Predictors of Self-Determination in Postsecondary Education

The # of social activities predicted scores on autonomy, self-realization, & overall self-determination

Social activities enhance self knowledge (self-awareness), understanding of what students enjoy (self-realization) and enhances choice and access to preferred activities (autonomy)



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Faculty experiences and attitudes

Faculty saw benefits to students with ID, to other students, to the classroom environment, and to themselves

Need for preparation and clarity of expectations and roles



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Student benefits

Increased student engagement in inclusive classrooms

Students with ID asked more clarifying questions than classmates

Classmates gained skills in collaboration and communication

increased classmates "empathy and awareness" and "propensity for inclusion"

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Faculty benefits



Successfully managing a diverse classroom led to increased confidence



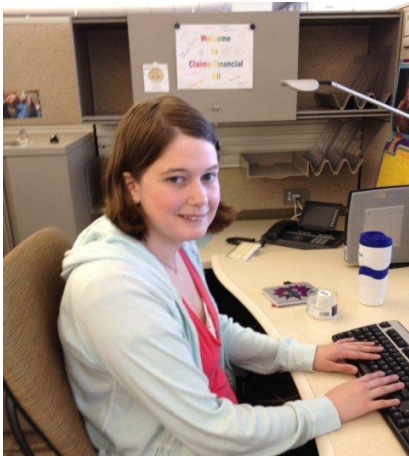
Helped faculty consider the range of student learning styles, educational experiences, and capabilities.



Improving their lectures by listening to the questions posed by students with ID.



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Perspectives of TPSID Employment Personnel

Career development and employment is impacted by the TPSIDs relationship with host IHE

Large disparity in approaches to career development, work-based learning, or employment supports.

Focus is more on unpaid work experiences rather than paid employment experiences.

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Predictor studies on TPSID data reveal



Enrolling in specialized courses is negatively associated with both having paid employment in the program and enrolling in inclusive courses



Unpaid career development experiences are not a significant predictor of students obtaining paid employment during the program.



Students who obtained a paid job while enrolled are almost 15 times more likely to have a paid job at exit than those who do not

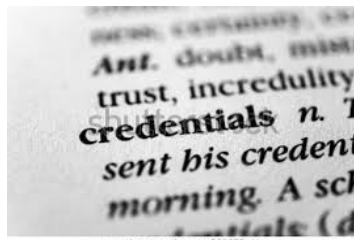


Students who have access to regular advising, earn an official transcript, or have a paid job enroll in more inclusive courses



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Predictors of paid employment at exit



- ✓ Earning a credential awarded by the IHE almost **doubled the odds** of having a paid job at exit



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“The TPSID model demonstration program has demonstrated what is possible when high expectations are paired with expanded opportunities and sufficient resources. By creating viable paths to and through higher education and coupling these experiences with a continued focus on employment, the TPSID programs support increased independence as well as personal and professional growth for students with intellectual disability.”

Grigal, M., Hart, D., Papay, C., Wu, X., Lazo, R., Smith, F., & Domin, D. (2021). Annual Report of the Cohort 2 TPSID Model Demonstration Projects (Year 5, 2019–2020). Boston, MA: University of Massachusetts Boston, Institute for Community Inclusion.



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